

Method One: Render Your Movie Twice

 One method you can try is to render your movie twice. After adding your first audio clip (background music), you can export your movie as a high-quality video file. Next, you can create a new WMM2 project and import that video file as one big video clip (don't let WMM2 automatically split the file into multiple clips!). You can then lay this video clip onto the video timeline and place your other audio material into the 'now empty' audio track.

The problem with this method is that your movie goes through an extra encoding step and loses some quality during this process. However, if you keep your export settings really high this degradation won't be noticeable. Another problem with this method is that you have to 'complete' your video before you can export the first file. However, this rendering method does give you a blank audio track and allows you to perform fine placement of many audio elements. If you are going to create a complicated video with music, voice track, and sound effects, then this is the route to choose.

Method Two: Superimpose The Two Tracks

 Another way to create two audio tracks is to superimpose them. WMM2 allows you to superimpose two audio clips using the same timeline track, though the method for doing this is not obvious.

First, lay down your music clip on the timeline. Then, lay your second audio track on the timeline after the first one. To superimpose the two, you first have to move the second clip so that its starting edge touches the end of the first audio clip. Now, pick up the second audio clip again and move it to the left. You'll see a blue 'triangle' form over the first audio track; that means they are superimposing. Unfortunately, there's a problem with this

method. If you try to completely superimpose both audio clips, so they both start at the beginning of the movie, the second clip will try to jump in front of the first one. It's really hard to get that second audio clip to start where you want it.

As you can see, running two audio tracks in WMM2 is problematic. But we should say that WMM2 is meant to be a simple video editor. If you find yourself needing multiple audio and video tracks that run concurrently, you may be better served with a professional editing package such as Adobe Premiere.

Adobe Premiere

Un-erase

 If you accidentally erase a project file, don't panic. Every time you save a project, Premiere saves over the file you're currently working on, but it will also save a copy of the previous version in its Project Archive folder—the folder that holds the actual application.

Project files are tiny compared to video files and they're worth any extra disk space you can allot. In 'Preferences (General and Undo)', you can specify how many versions of a single project Premiere will keep an archive of (up to 100), and the total number of archives Premiere will keep (up to 1,000).

In And Out

 When editing clips in the Source window, holding down [Alt] and dragging the In or Out points will split them into separate Video and Audio In/Out points, allowing for an L or J cut before the clip is even in the timeline. While [Alt] is held down, the In and Out points for audio and video are edited separately.

Poster Frame

 If you have several clips that contain similar footage at the beginning, it may be tough to tell which is which. If you have a clip

selected, Premiere will show you the first frame in the clip in the clip preview window. However, you can move the scrubber to a different part of the clip, and click the small screen icon in the corner of the clip window. This will tell Premiere to use that particular frame as the 'poster' frame.

Export Bin

 If you would like to use the same collection of clips in another project, Premiere allows you to export the contents of a bin to a text file. But finding this feature is a little tricky. With the bin selected, you can go to the Project menu and choose

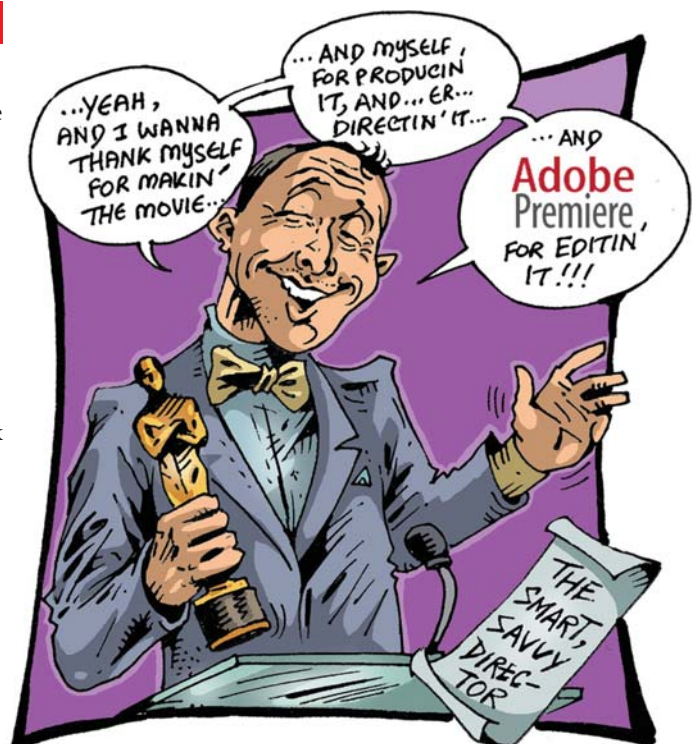
set to specific F-keys so you can quickly switch between an audio layout of the palettes and one for effects.

Master Clip

 Double-clicking a trimmed clip in the timeline will open that edited clip in the monitor window. [Ctrl] + [Shift] + double-click will open the Master clip in the monitor window with the current clip's in and out points. In this way, more than one segment can be pulled from a Master clip.

Batch It

 Batch capture saves you hard drive space as well as archiving space by



'Export Bin From Project'. You can also right-click a particular bin and choose to export the contents.

To open the bin, open it as if it was any other document and Premiere will use it accordingly. When opened, the bin will exist in its own window. You can drag and drop the bin or its contents to your current project.

Customise

 Premiere lets you customise the F-keys to choose options in menus. For example, workspaces can be

'previewing' the video before you capture it. Using a saved 'batch list', getting back your video is simply a matter of capturing from the original tape using the list. This feature is accessed by going to File > Capture > Batch Capture.

Audio Editing

 To anyone editing sound in Premiere, the small workspace in the audio track doesn't give you much in the way of precision. Holding down [Shift] while adjusting points in the audio will give